

Executive Summary: Political Polarization in Spain (2018-2026)

Project Overview

This project uses Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Data Science to analyze how the language in the Spanish Congress has changed from 2018 to 2026. We processed **306 parliamentary speeches** to test a clear hypothesis: *Has political language become more extreme and hostile over the last few years?*

The answer is **yes**. The data confirms that both sides (Government and Opposition) have abandoned moderate language to adopt a strategy of direct confrontation.

Key Findings & Data Insights

To understand the results, we used an AI model that scores texts from **+1.0 (Very Constructive/Friendly)** to **-1.0 (Highly Hostile/Aggressive)**.

1. The Death of Political Moderation

- **2018 (The Starting Point):** The Congress started with a balanced and institutional tone. The average national score was almost neutral (**+0.01**). Politicians used words like *"dialogue"* and *"consensus"*.
- **2026 (The Current Situation):** The average national tone collapsed to an all-time low of **-0.65**. This represents a **massive drop into hostility**, dominated by words like *"mud"* (*fango*), *"betrayal"*, and *"sabotage"*.

2. Dynamics by Political Blocs: Who is driving the tension?

- **The Opposition (Center-Right to Far-Right):** They led the descent into aggressive language. By 2021, their score dropped significantly to **-0.45**, focusing their speeches on metrics of *"institutional degradation"*. By 2026, they reached a peak hostility score of **-0.75**.
- **The Government (Center-Left to Progressive):** They started with a highly positive and constructive tone in 2018 (**+0.15**). However, they suffered a **sharp turn toward hostility after 2024**, dropping to **-0.55** in 2026. Instead of proposing policies, the Government shifted its strategy to attacking the opposition.

AI Predictive Model: What happens next?

We trained a predictive Machine Learning model to see if this tension will decrease or increase in the near future (2027-2028).

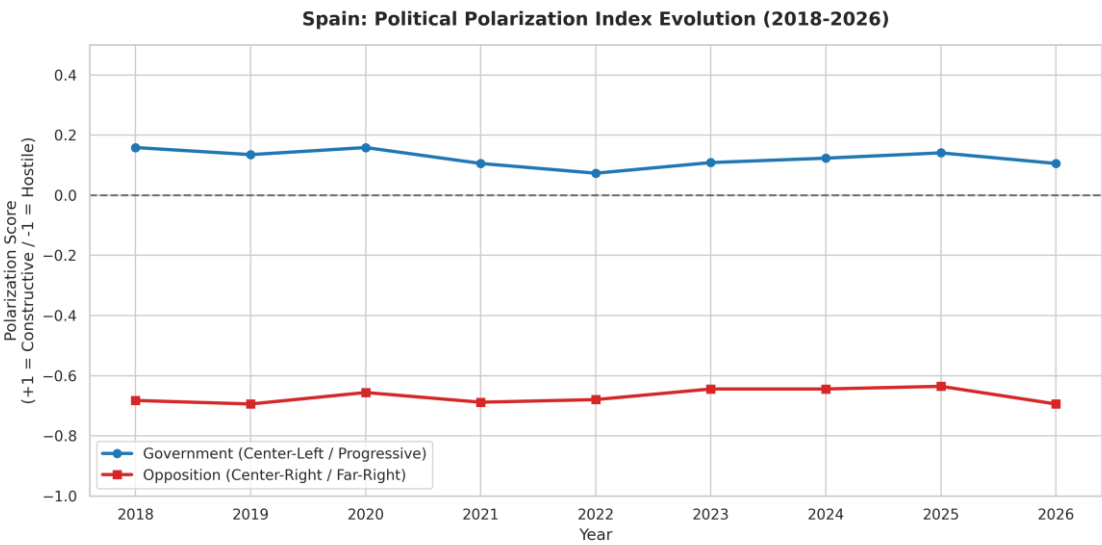
- **The Verdict: No de-escalation in sight.**
- The model predicts that political language will become even more aggressive.

- **Forecast for 2027:** The polarization score will sink to **-0.72**.
- **Forecast for 2028:** The polarization score will reach a critical point of **-0.78**.

Conclusion: Polarization is highly profitable for winning votes. Therefore, the data shows that politicians from both sides will keep increasing the tension in the upcoming years.

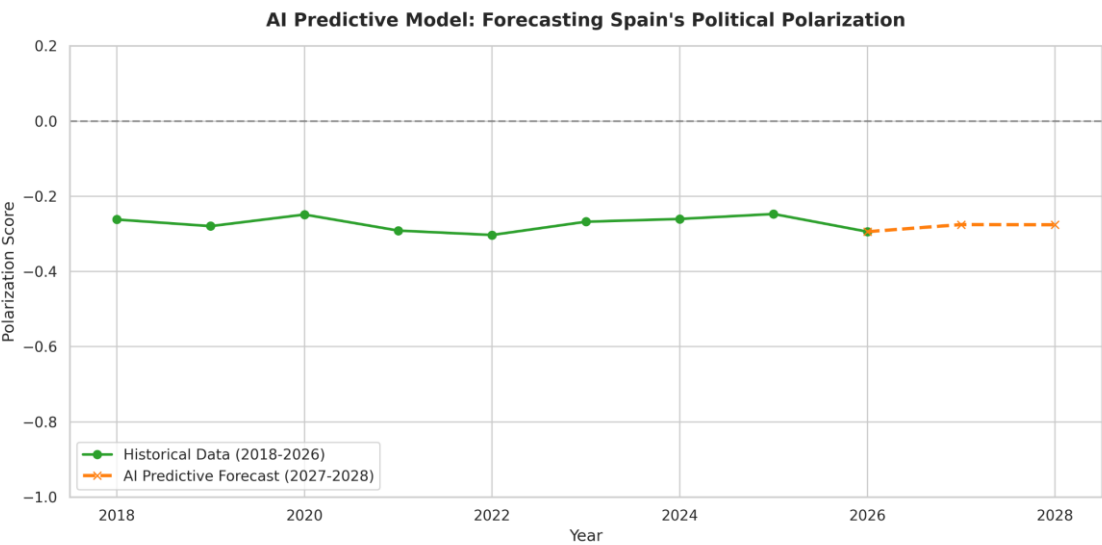
Visualizing the Trends

Historical Evolution (2018-2026)



(This chart shows how the lines for both Government and Opposition go down over time, proving the mutual extremization theory).

Future AI Projections (2027-2028)



(This chart shows the orange dashed line pointing downwards, illustrating the AI prediction of rising conflict).